

Contact Sheet		Digital Cameras	
Brand	Company	Phone	Web Site
Canon	Canon India P Ltd	0124-5160000	www.canon.co.in
Samsung Premier	Samsung India Electronics P Ltd	011-41511234	www.samsung.com/in
	Mediatech India Distribution P Ltd	022-26361111	www.mediatechindia.com
Sony	Macro Photo	022-22618639	www.sonyindia.co.in
Nikon	Macro Photo	022-22618639	www.nikon.co.in
Kodak	Kodak India P Ltd	022-56416819	www.kodak.co.in
Olympus	Macro Photo	022-22618639	www.olympus.com
Tech-Com	Shree Sagarmatha Dist. P Ltd	011-26428541	www.techcomindia.com

detail—the text on the bottle was very clear—but the colours seemed a touch lacklustre; faded, if you will.

We were pretty surprised by the Canon Ixus 60's rather dismal performance. Although this is a sleek model aimed at making a fashion statement (which it does), but quality of output is a camera's bread and butter, and we do not like compromises there. In our outdoor photo shoot, three cameras stood a shoulder above the others—the Sony W-50, Samsung S-800, and the Canon A-700, in that order. The Sony impressed the most with its outdoor abilities: the detailing on our building and on the shrubs was excellent.

The rest of the models also performed acceptably well here, with the exception of the Digital Ixus 60 and the Kodak V570. There was slight pixelation in both images, and the shadows between the leaves in particular lacked detail and depth.

Home Ad

The Verdict The Sub-8,500 Category— Budget Performers

The winner of the Digit Best Buy Gold award in the sub-8,500 category is the Nikon Coolpix L4. At a price of Rs 7,500, you get a solid camera that performs well and isn't shy on the feature count. Our Silver award belongs to the Premier DC-5370; this camera battled it out with the L4 and its slightly costlier sibling, the DC-6370, won; but in the end lost out to the Nikon marginally in terms of sheer performance.

Rs 8,500 to Rs 14,999— Mid-Range Cameras

Our Gold award in this category goes to the best fusion of show and go—the Sony DSC L-1. The Nikon S5 bags the Silver award. There was no real competition from the others for these two. Also, they were neck and neck in all the tests, but the L1 won largely due to its aggressive pricing.

Rs 15,000 And Above—High-Enders

Gold is once again in Sony territory with the W-50, which is Rs 15,000. Bagging the award from among costlier models is no small feat, and the Cybershot W-50 does this with style. Waltzing into second position is another excellent camera—the Samsung S-800; we bestow it with our Digit Best Buy Silver award.



Samsung Digimax S-800
Clear and crisp—just what the doctor ordered

In Sum

Our digital camera test this time round was rather interesting, with a new brand, Premier, being thrown into the mix of Sonys, Canons, and so on. We very nearly lived with these cameras for over a week, clicking away without reservation.

With the convenience offered by these devices and the amount of detail they can produce, even hardcore sceptics were swept away (we do have some old-timers around who still believe film rules). Quite a few from among our band of disbelievers are—even as you read this—planning to take the digital plunge. Those that can't just yet have begun saving up for one of these shiny new shooters! ■

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